Romain Rubens

Product & Interaction Designer | Connected Ecosystems & Smart Home

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Professional Summary

Product & Interaction Design student specializing in smart home environments and connected ecosystems. I leverage human-centered design, systems thinking, and user research to translate complex technical architecture into seamless, intuitive multimodal experiences. Driven by a strong design-to-development bridge, I collaborate effectively with cross-functional teams to build scalable solutions grounded in real-world user needs.

Technical Skills

Figma | Sketch | FigJam | Photoshop | Illustrator | InDesign | Acrobat | After Effects | Jitter
Miro | Mural | Notion | Condens | Tally | Typeform | Xcode | Replit | Lovable | Claude Code | Stitch | Codex

Education

Strate School of Design / 2023 - 2028 (expected)
Master's-Level Diploma in Industrial Design *- UX & Interaction Design Specialization*
Critical Thinking | UX/UI Design | Design Systems | Prototyping

Apple Developer Academy | MSU / October 2026
Apple Foundation Program
UX Research | Human-Centered Design | iOS Prototyping & Development

College for Creative Studies (CCS) / Fall 2026
Graduate Exchange Semester *- User Experience & Interaction Design*
UX Research | UI Design | Interaction Design | Brand Strategy

Columbia University | Columbia+ / 2026 - Present
Non-Degree Continuing Education
Artificial Intelligence | Programming | Cybersecurity | Emerging Technologies

La Martinière Diderot High-School / 2020 - 2022
French Technological Baccalaureate (STI2D)
Technological Innovation | Product Design | Sustainability

Professional Experience

Product & Design System Designer | Intern / March 2026 - July 2026
Goupil Electric Vehicles, Polaris Group *- Bordeaux, France*

- **Led** end-to-end UX initiatives across a multi-platform B2B digital ecosystem, aligning software interfaces with industrial hardware constraints.
- **Conducted** comprehensive user research through stakeholder interviews, co-design workshops, audits, and field observations.
- **Mapped** complex user journeys, stakeholder ecosystems, and service blueprints to identify strategic product opportunities.
- Designed responsive web and mobile interfaces tailored for end-customers, dealership networks, and technical field operators.
- **Architected and deployed** 'SyGo', the official Design System, establishing design tokens, layout grids, components, and WCAG accessibility guidelines.
- **Collaborated** with cross-functional engineering teams to streamline front-end developer handoff and product strategy.
- **Delivered** high-fidelity interactive prototypes, edge-case user flows, and technical UX specifications for production-ready digital products.

Product & Interaction Designer | Academic Industry Project / September 2025 - February 2026
Renault Group × Strate - *Lyon, France*

- **Conceptualized and designed** an AI-powered smart extension for the flagship Renault mobile application, focusing on connected mobility.
- **Executed** generative user research, opportunity gap analysis, and human-centered concept development for future automotive ecosystems.
- **Synthesized** user insights into detailed interaction flows, complex information architecture, and high-fidelity UI solutions.
- **Engineered** high-fidelity interactive prototypes, executing iterative usability testing cycles to refine interface states and motion design.
- **Presented** advanced design recommendations and final interactive concepts directly to Renault Group executive stakeholders.

Interaction Designer | Inter-University Project / September 2025 - January 2026
Strate School of Design × ENTPE - *For SGAR Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur, France*

- **Co-designed** interactive tools and digital educational materials within a cross-disciplinary team, exploring multimodal interactions to promote sustainable behaviors.
- **Applied** behavioral analysis, systems thinking, and usability testing to ensure high user engagement in complex corporate environments.

Volunteer Digital Skills Instructor / September 2023 - September 2025
Les Équipes Saint-Vincent - *Lyon, France*

- **Developed and delivered** digital literacy workshops, translating complex technical workflows into accessible learning modules.
- **Advocated** for digital inclusion and accessibility, resolving user friction points for diverse and non-technical audiences.

Volunteer Digital Skills Mentor / *October 2023 - September 2025*
Le Pari Solidaire - Villeurbanne, France

- **Provided** one-on-one technical mentoring and communication support, improving digital autonomy and accessibility.
- **Evaluated** individual user pain points to build tailored, empathetic step-by-step navigation flows.

Core Competencies

UX Design: User research | Stakeholder and user interviews | Usability testing | Insight synthesis | Journey mapping | User flows | Personas | Prioritization matrices | Behavioral analysis | Heuristic evaluation | Accessibility | WCAG standards | Wireframing | Interactive prototyping | Systems thinking · Complex ecosystem mapping | Interface audits | Design research & trend monitoring

UI Design: Design systems | Components | Auto Layout | Responsive grids | Design sprints | High-fidelity interfaces | Cross-platform design | Iconography | Motion design | Interaction design | Visual hierarchy | Typography | Interface states

Connected Ecosystems: Apple Home | Google Home | Amazon Alexa | Matter | Thread | Homebridge | Philips Hue | IKEA Home smart | Aqara | Samsung SmartThings | Sonos | Tuya/Smart Life | Xiaomi Home | Nanoleaf

Languages

French: Native | **Armenian:** Bilingual | **English:** Professional | **Spanish:** Scholar | **Russian:** Basic

Certifications

Google AI Essentials / *December 2025*
Google Career Certificate, Coursera

PIX - Digital Skills Certification / *Jun 2022*
Level 7 - Expert